China's military intervention in Tibet was a new situation for India. Deputy Prime Minister Patel's letter to Prime Minister Nehru on 7 November 1950 laid out the challenge in stark terms. Not only did Patel consider China as having deluded India by professions of peaceful intention, but he declared that China was not a friend but a potential enemy. Patel, therefore, recommended that India give its immediate attention to dealing with some of the potential problems, among which he listed the India–Tibet boundary (McMahon Line) as well as the future of the Indian presence inside Tibet that India had inherited from the British Empire. The Chinese envoy in Delhi had already, in his meeting with Foreign Secretary K.P.S. Menon on 2 November 1950, conveyed that China did not recognize the Indian privileges in Tibet. The Chinese ambassador declared that these were unauthorized and violated the principle of sovereignty and territorial integrity. This was quite different from the verbal assurance that Zhou had reportedly given Panikkar in September 1949. [15] The post-invasion scenario offered good reason for the Government of India to undertake a comprehensive review of strategy and tactics. Since the Chinese ambassador in New Delhi had indicated that the new regime would not respect earlier agreements, it gave rise to opportunity to raise matters concerning Tibet as well.

The period between November 1950 and the end of 1951 marked the second phase of the India–China negotiations over Tibet. China continued with its step-by-step approach. They realized that merely obtaining physical possession of Tibet by force did not guarantee China's position in Tibet. Their next objective was to legitimize China's control over Tibet and physically consolidate their presence on the ground since the PLA was thinly spread in some parts of Tibet. The aim was to quell domestic (Tibetan) opposition and to neutralize the possibility of any external support for the Tibetan resistance